

for those of us who still like to read, technology doing away with the need for publishers altogether and giving people the ability to self publish books means that just about anyone who wants to invest time in writing and following basic publishing guidelines can publish an ebook. And does the ebook need to be factual, or vetted, or follow any established standards of telling the truth? Of course not. If you wanted to, you could write a book about how Digit is plotting to take over the world by collaborating with aliens from Proxima Centauri B to slowly turn everyone against technology.

tech savvy people across the country certainly seem to be mimicking the US and other countries in the way we approach dating, which might not be the best idea. Let's understand some of the problems the west is having and try and figure out a way to avoid repeating those same mistakes.

For starters, dating is becoming more of a window shopping experience, with no real scope for the individuality of a person to shine. Unless of course that can be expressed visually in the few pictures people see of you before deciding your fate. In fact, a lot of people are doing more research before buying a phone than

yours, depending on who has more matches to choose from. And if you've been doing this for a while, you've already heard all of the lines in the book, so people are far more likely to fail to please you. Assuming all of that also works, and you end up meeting someone on a date, both you and they might have many more matches that they're already thinking about as well, so they don't really care about how well this date goes, and are quick to reject you based on some frivolous flaw or the other. Plenty of fish...

Assuming you hit it off, and there is a second date, or more, it's all still frivolous and easy, and not to be taken seriously at all, or else you come across as clingy, which is terrible! Being aloof and self-centered is the norm, because that's what social media expects us to be – confident to the point of narcissism.

Even if you do get serious, technology will always be there to distract you from everything, and so many couples are now spending time "together" by sitting in restaurants or coffee shops, both on their own phones, taking the odd break to smile at one another or indulge in small talk, or to show their phone to their partner.

If that's the future awaiting all of us anyway, maybe our ancestors were right all along when they arranged marriages for convenience and wealth!

MEMORY

With all of the junk that goes into our heads on a daily basis, it's no wonder we don't have the ability to remember important things anymore. With everything being a mere internet search away, many of us don't even feel the need to remember stuff that's important for work!

So many of us go through lives holding up phones and trying to record every little event, because we mistakenly believe that this will help us remember the event better. Often the opposite is true, and studies have been done to prove that! Being focussed on capturing an event through a camera actually makes you miss tiny details about the event that



Credit: ESO/M. Kornmesser

Ross 128 b awaits. Keep reading the magazine to find out more

Just to be clear, we're not doing any of that! We're only in touch with aliens from Ross 128 b, and they're really nice...

DATING

Let's face it, dating is still new to millions of our fellow Indians, but it's something that's catching on. While we have people hooking up on Tinder, we've also got others marrying one another without ever meeting in person, and such is the diversity of our country and the cultures it contains within it. That said, the

they do about people they head off on dates with.

The "Everything is Awesome" feel that the world seems to want to show off creeps into our dating profiles as well. Then again, since most people have just a second or two to make an impression before they're swiped left on for good, it's only appearances that matter – and people become commodities, lined up on a shelf, on display.

Assuming you do match with someone, you now have a single line to capture their attention, or they